

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer>C . The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder .

<think> Reasoning process here :

- 1 . The patient's persistent feelings of hopelessness , guilt , and preoccupation with negative thoughts and catastrophizing are indicative of a pervasive pattern of negative thoughts and behaviors that are not better explained by a manic or psychotic disorder .
- 2 . The patient's difficulty making decisions and experiencing worsening suicidal ideations can be associated with depressive disorders , but the duration and pattern of symptoms described suggests that this is not the primary issue .
- 3 . Anhedonia , or the inability to experience pleasure , is a common symptom of depressive disorders and is also a trait feature of paranoid personality disorder .
- 4 . Paranoid personality disorder is characterized by a pervasive distrust and suspiciousness of others , which can manifest as catastrophizing and a sense of being "cursed" or hopeless , similar to the patient's description .
- 5 . Double depression , while a legitimate psychiatric diagnosis , involves a combination of major depressive episodes and significant symptoms of depression throughout a substantial portion of the day (more than 2 days in adults) .
- 6 . Mania or psychosis typically involves significant episodes of elevated mood , or a break from reality , characterized by bizarre and/or disorganized thinking , mood , and behavior . While these can occur in a variety of psychiatric conditions , they do not align with the chronic , low-grade symptoms described by the patient .